

Email Deliverability & Inbox Mastery Guide

Product 42 - Email Deliverability & Inbox Mastery Guide

Niche: Affiliate Marketing / Email (advanced)

Format: Deliverability guide + pre-send checklist

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You can write the best promo email in the world - if it lands in spam, you earn nothing. This guide shows buyers how to **reach the inbox**, lift open rates, and protect their sender reputation, so every promo actually gets seen.

What's inside

- This guide - how deliverability works + the levers you control
- deliverability-checklist.md - setup + pre-send checklist

How inbox placement actually works

Mailbox providers (Gmail, Outlook, etc.) decide inbox vs. spam based on:

1. **Authentication** - are you really who you say you are? (SPF, DKIM, DMARC)
2. **Reputation** - your sending domain/IP history.
3. **Engagement** - do people open, click, and reply? (or delete/mark spam?)
4. **Content** - spammy words, too many links, bad formatting.
5. **List hygiene** - are you emailing dead/invalid addresses?

You can't control the algorithm, but you control all five inputs.

The 5 levers you control

1. Authentication(set once)

Set up SPF, DKIM, and DMARC for your sending domain. This is the single biggest technical factor. Most autoresponders provide step-by-step instructions.

2. Reputation (build over time)

- Warm up new domains/sending slowly.
- Be consistent (sudden blasts hurt).
- Use a custom domain, not a free address, as the "from."

3. Engagement (the modern #1 factor)

- Email people who want to hear from you (good lead magnet = good list).
- Send valuable content, not just pitches.
- Remove/segment people who never open.
- Ask for replies early (boosts reputation).

4. Content

- Avoid spam-trigger words and ALL CAPS / excessive punctuation!!!
- Keep a healthy text-to-link ratio (1-2 links often beats 10).
- Don't attach files or use deceptive subject lines.
- Include a clear unsubscribe link.

5. List hygiene

- Use double opt-in where possible.
- Clean inactive subscribers regularly (re-engage, then remove).
- Never buy lists (instant reputation death).

Lifting open rates (so engagement stays high)

- Write subject lines for curiosity/benefit (Product 17).
- Send when your audience is active (test times).
- Keep a consistent, recognizable "from" name.
- Re-engage or prune non-openers (a smaller engaged list beats a big dead one).

Warning signs you have a deliverability problem

- Open rates suddenly drop.
- Clicks fall off a cliff.
- Subscribers say they can't find your emails.
- Spam complaints rise.

How to use (for the affiliate)

1. Set up SPF/DKIM/DMARC for your sending domain (one-time).
2. Run the per-send checklist before every broadcast.
3. Prioritize engagement: value first, prune non-openers.
4. Monitor open/click trends; act fast if they dip.

Deliverability Checklist

One-time setup (do this first)

- ☐ Use a custom sending domain (not @gmail/@yahoo as the "from")
- ☐ Set up **SPF** record
- ☐ Set up **DKIM** signing

- ☐ Set up **DMARC** policy
- ☐ Verify your domain in your autoresponder
- ☐ Set a recognizable "from" name + reply-to you monitor
- ☐ Add a physical address + unsubscribe link to your template (often legally required)
- ☐ Enable double opt-in if available

New domain/account warm-up

- ☐ Start with your most engaged subscribers
- ☐ Increase sending volume gradually over 2-4 weeks
- ☐ Keep early content valuable (high opens = fast reputation build)
- ☐ Ask a few early subscribers to reply (signals legitimacy)

Per-send checklist(run before every broadcast)

Subject + from

- ☐ Subject is honest (no deceptive "RE:" tricks)
- ☐ No ALL CAPS, no excessive !!! or \$\$\$
- ☐ Consistent "from" name

Content

- ☐ 1-2 links (not 10+)
- ☐ Healthy text-to-image ratio (don't send image-only emails)
- ☐ No spam-trigger overload ("free money", "guaranteed income", "act now!!!")
- ☐ No attachments
- ☐ Personalized where possible (name, segment)
- ☐ Clear, working unsubscribe link
- ☐ Mobile-friendly formatting

Targeting

- ☐ Sending to engaged/relevant segment (not the whole dead list)
- ☐ Suppressed hard-bounces and unsubscribes
- ☐ Good send time for the audience

Monthly list hygiene

- ☐ Identify subscribers who haven't opened in 60-90 days
- ☐ Send a re-engagement email ("still want these?")
- ☐ Remove/suppress those who don't re-engage
- ☐ Review bounce + complaint rates
- ☐ Check open/click trend vs. last month

Spam-trigger words to use sparingly

Free, guarantee, income, cash, \$\$\$, act now, limited time, risk-free, winner, click

here, urgent, congratulations, 100%, make money. (A few are fine in context - it's overuse + bad reputation that triggers filters.)

Quick diagnosis

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Sudden open-rate drop	Reputation/engagement	Prune non-openers, send value
New emails to spam	Auth missing/broken	Verify SPF/DKIM/DMARC
High complaints	List quality/expectations	Better opt-in, set expectations
Low opens always	Subject lines / from name	Test subjects (Product 17)

Authenticate, stay consistent, prioritize engagement, and keep the list clean. The inbox is earned, not given.